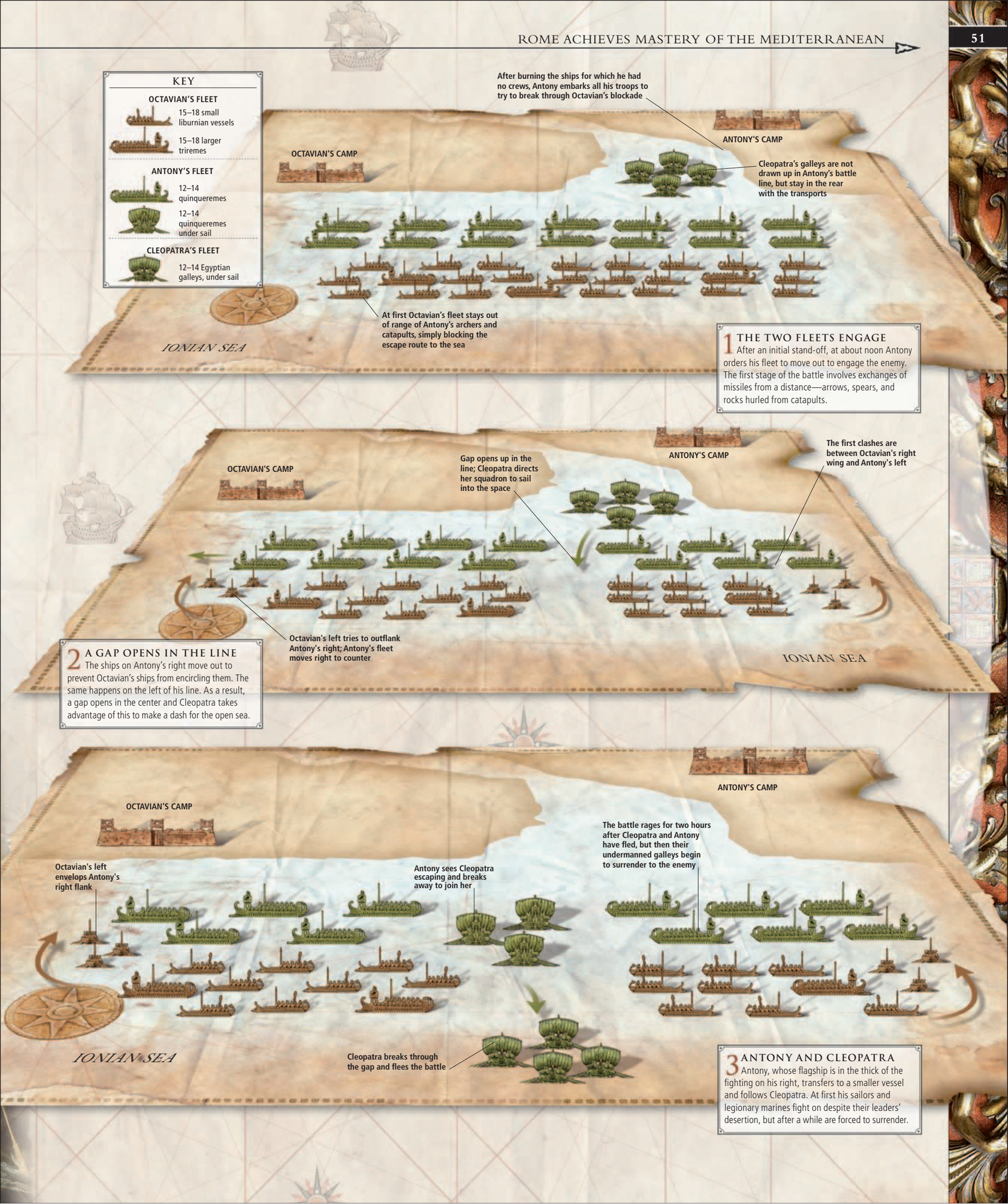

KEY
OCTAVIAN'S FLEET
15–18 small liburnian vessels
15–18 larger triremes
ANTONY'S FLEET
12–14 quinqueremes
12–14 quinqueremes under sail
CLEOPATRA'S FLEET
12–14 Egyptian galleys, under sail
After burning the ships for which he had no crews, Antony embarks all his troops to try to break through Octavian's blockade
ANTONY'S CAMP
OCTAVIAN'S CAMP
Cleopatra's galleys are not drawn up in Antony's battle line, but stay in the rear with the transports
At first Octavian's fleet stays out of range of Antony's archers and catapults, simply blocking the escape route to the sea
IONIAN SEA
1 THE TWO FLEETS ENGAGE
After an initial stand-off, at about noon Antony orders his fleet to move out to engage the enemy. The first stage of the battle involves exchanges of missiles from a distance—arrows, spears, and rocks hurled from catapults.
ANTONY'S CAMP
OCTAVIAN'S CAMP
Gap opens up in the line; Cleopatra directs her squadron to sail into the space
The first clashes are between Octavian's right wing and Antony's left
Octavian's left tries to outflank Antony's right; Antony's fleet moves right to counter
IONIAN SEA
2 A GAP OPENS IN THE LINE
The ships on Antony's right move out to prevent Octavian's ships from encircling them. The same happens on the left of his line. As a result, a gap opens in the center and Cleopatra takes advantage of this to make a dash for the open sea.
ANTONY'S CAMP
OCTAVIAN'S CAMP
Octavian's left envelops Antony's right flank
Antony sees Cleopatra escaping and breaks away to join her
The battle rages for two hours after Cleopatra and Antony have fled, but then their undermanned galleys begin to surrender to the enemy
IONIAN SEA
Cleopatra breaks through the gap and flees the battle
3 ANTONY AND CLEOPATRA
Antony, whose flagship is in the thick of the fighting on his right, transfers to a smaller vessel and follows Cleopatra. At first his sailors and legionary marines fight on despite their leaders' desertion, but after a while are forced to surrender.